

Kitchen & *Kettle*

# Food Preservation Logbook

TRACK WHAT YOU PRESERVE. REMEMBER WHAT WORKED.

Canning logs, fermentation  
trackers, dehydrating notes, and a  
seasonal produce guide —  
everything you need to keep track of  
a year of preserving, in one place.

No food is truly preserved if you forget where you put it.

# How to use this logbook

The point of preserving food is to eat it later. This logbook makes sure "later" actually happens — and that you remember what worked so you can do it again.

## WHAT'S INSIDE

1. **Canning log** — Record every batch. Recipe, date, yield, processing method, and how it turned out when you opened it.
2. **Fermentation tracker** — Start date, ingredients, salt ratio, tasting notes. Ferments change over time — track the journey.
3. **Dehydrating notes** — What you dried, how you prepped it, temperature, time, and whether the result was worth repeating.
4. **Seasonal produce guide** — What's in season when, and what to do with it. Reference pages, not blank templates.

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## WHEN TO USE EACH SECTION

- **During preserving season** (summer/fall): Fill out logs as you go. Don't wait — you'll forget details.
- **When you open a jar** (all year): Go back and add notes. Was the texture good? Too salty? Perfect? This is the most valuable data.
- **Before next year's season:** Review last year's logs. Double the pickles, skip the pear butter, try that new hot sauce recipe.

*The notes column is the most important field on every page. "Tasted flat — add more vinegar next time" is worth more than any recipe. Write down what actually happened.*

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## A NOTE ON SAFETY

This logbook assumes you already know safe canning and fermentation practices. If you're new to preserving, consult tested recipes and safety guidelines (USDA, NCHFP, or a reputable modern preserving book) before filling these pages.

*The processing time and method fields exist because they matter for safety. Don't skip them. Botulism is rare but real — follow tested recipes.*

# Canning Log

Year: \_\_\_\_\_

Fill this out the same day you process. Memory is unreliable — especially during a marathon canning session.

| DATE  | RECIPE / CONTENTS | JARS / SIZE | METHOD  | TIME  | YIELD | RESULT / NOTES |
|-------|-------------------|-------------|---------|-------|-------|----------------|
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB / PC | _____ | _____ | _____          |

WB = water bath   PC = pressure canner   Record processing time per tested recipe.

# Canning Log (continued)

Year: \_\_\_\_\_

| DATE  | RECIPE / CONTENTS | JARS / SIZE | METHOD | TIME  | YIELD | RESULT / NOTES |
|-------|-------------------|-------------|--------|-------|-------|----------------|
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |
| _____ | _____             | _____       | WB/PC  | _____ | _____ | _____          |

## YEAR-END REVIEW

Total jars processed this year: \_\_\_\_\_

Best batch (make again for sure): \_\_\_\_\_

Worst batch (skip next year): \_\_\_\_\_

What to do differently next year: \_\_\_\_\_

# Fermentation Tracker

Year: \_\_\_\_\_

*Ferments are alive — they change. Taste every few days and write notes. The day something tastes perfect is the day it goes in the fridge.*

| STARTED                                         | RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT | SALT RATIO / BRINE % |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>TASTING NOTES</b>                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other |                       |                      |

| STARTED                                         | RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT | SALT RATIO / BRINE % |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>TASTING NOTES</b>                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other |                       |                      |

| STARTED                                         | RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT | SALT RATIO / BRINE % |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>TASTING NOTES</b>                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other |                       |                      |

| STARTED                                         | RECIPE / WHAT'S IN IT | SALT RATIO / BRINE % |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>TASTING NOTES</b>                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Day __ (____): _____                            |                       |                      |
| Ready on: _____ Stored: fridge / cellar / other |                       |                      |

# Dehydrating Notes

Write down what you dried, how you prepped it, and whether it was worth the effort. Some things dehydrate beautifully (tomatoes, herbs, mushrooms). Some don't (cucumbers — don't bother).

| DATE | FOOD  | PREP METHOD | TEMP | TIME | RESULT / WORTH IT? |
|------|-------|-------------|------|------|--------------------|
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |
| ___  | _____ | _____       | ___° | ___h | _____              |

## Seasonal Produce at a Glance

Northern hemisphere, temperate climate. Adjust for your region. **Key:** F = freeze C = can D = dehydrate L = lacto-ferment R = root cellar

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><b>SPRING</b></div> <div>AsparagusFC</div> <div>PeasF</div> <div>RhubarbFC</div> <div>Greens (spinach, chard)FD</div> <div>RadishesL</div> <div>Herbs (tender)DF</div> <div>StrawberriesFCD</div>                                        | <div><b>SUMMER</b></div> <div>TomatoesCFD</div> <div>CucumbersLC</div> <div>Zucchini / squashFD</div> <div>PeppersFDC</div> <div>Green beansCFL</div> <div>CornFC</div> <div>Berries (all kinds)FCD</div> <div>Stone fruitCFD</div>                                       |
| <div><b>AUTUMN</b></div> <div>Apples / pearsCDR</div> <div>Winter squashR</div> <div>PumpkinFCR</div> <div>Root vegetablesRL</div> <div>CabbageLR</div> <div>Brussels sproutsFR</div> <div>CranberriesFCD</div> <div>Mushrooms (wild)DF</div> | <div><b>WINTER</b></div> <div>CitrusD (peel) C (marmalade)</div> <div>Root veg (stored)use from cellar</div> <div>Apples / pears (stored)use from cellar</div> <div>Winter squash (stored)use from cellar</div> <div>Preserved goods</div> <div>eat what you put up</div> |

## A note on preserving

Preserving food isn't about stockpiling for the apocalypse. It's about capturing a moment of abundance — the week tomatoes are perfect, the month apples are falling off the tree — and spreading that abundance across the rest of the year.

Your grandmother's generation did this because they had to. You're doing it because you want to. That's a privilege. Enjoy it.

Some years you'll put up fifty jars of peaches and feel like a genius. Other years you'll preserve exactly nothing and eat takeout all August. Both years are fine. The logbook is here when you want it — not as an obligation.

### FAVORITE RECIPES TO REPEAT

### NEW THINGS TO TRY NEXT YEAR

### EQUIPMENT TO ACQUIRE / REPLACE

### GOOD SOURCES FOR PRODUCE

Kitchen & Kettle • Works because it works.

A quieter way to run a kitchen.